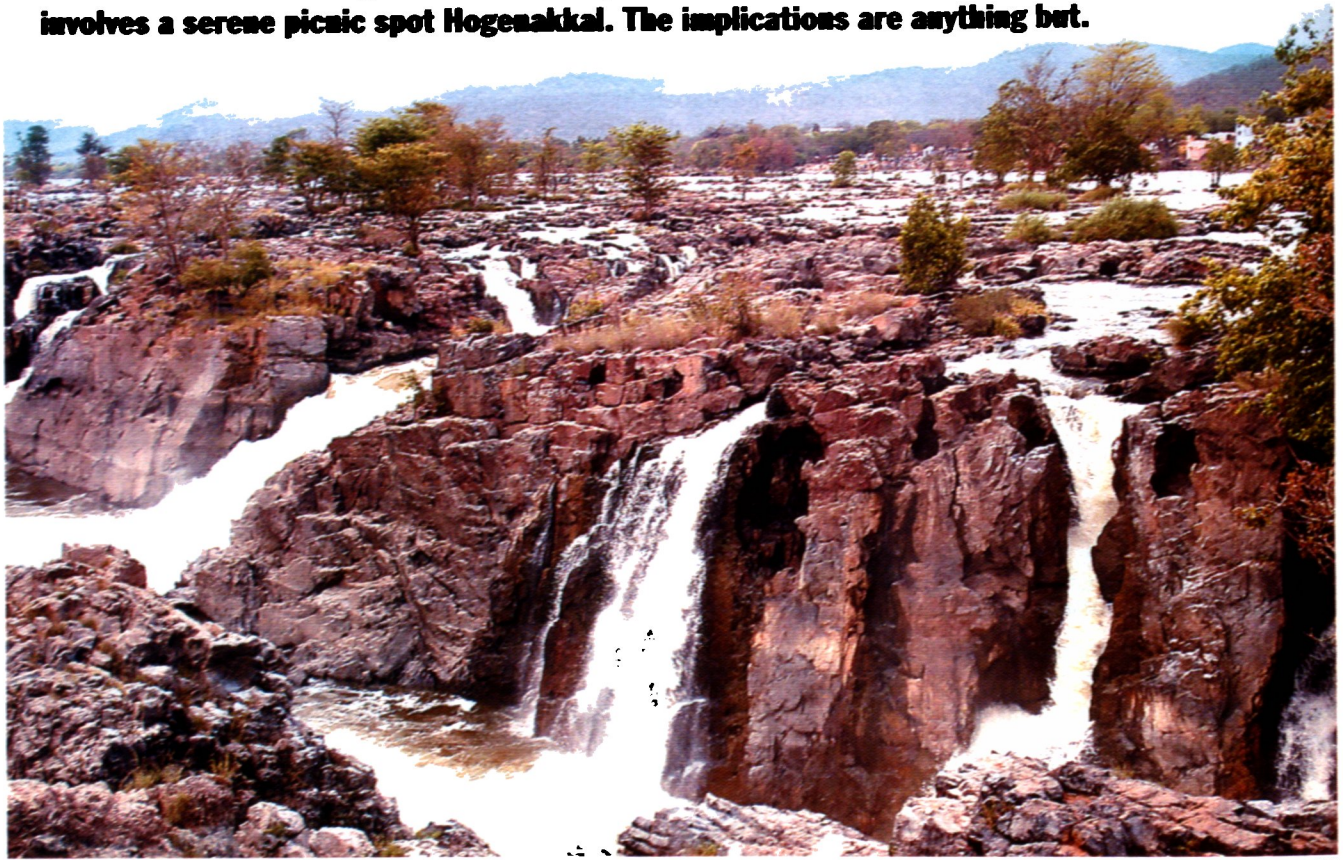


IN TROUBLED WATERS

The border row involving the river Cauvery between Karnataka and Tamil Nadu involves a serene picnic spot Hogenakkal. The implications are anything but.



■ By Stephen David

Three hours drive beyond Hosur from Bangalore, the popular picnic spot Hogenakkal—where the river Cauvery falls almost 150 ft with such force that some dub it as a local version of Niagara—is in the news for all the wrong reasons. Hogenakkal in Kannada literally translates as smoke and rock: hoge means smoke and kal signifies rock. That is eerily symbolic of the fresh row that has erupted between Tamil Nadu and Karnataka over the sharing of the river waters. Kannada activists threw rocks and there was plenty of smoke as well at the inauguration of a Rs 1,334-crore drinking water supply project in Dharmapuri district by Tamil Nadu Chief Minister M. Karunanidhi on February 26. Kannada Chaluvali Paksha leader Vatal Nagaraj, who staged a protest on the occasion has urged



Karnataka Governor Rameshwar Thakur to convey the state's reservations over the project to the Centre.

Nagaraj says the project will affect the supply of drinking water to Karnataka and alleges that Tamil Nadu's move is not in accordance with the final order of the Cauvery river tribunal. Expectedly, Kannada groups have started venting their ire against cinema halls screening Tamil films. Even the apolitical Bangalore Tamil Sangam, which has the

CASCADE: Waterfall at Hogenakkal reputation of conducting some of the most popular Kannada classes, was under attack, which forced it to lodge a police complaint.

Karnataka's Chief Conservator of Forest A.K. Verma has sought details from the chief conservator of forests of the Chamarajnagar district over Tamil Nadu Government's plans to take up drinking water and power generation projects at Hogenakkal. BJP leaders like H.N. Ananth Kumar and former chief minister B.S. Yeddiyurappa have already said that Tamil Nadu should await a clearance from the Central Ground Water Commission.

Another pro-Kannada group Karnataka Rakshana Vedike has urged Advocate General B.V. Acharya to inform the Supreme Court on Tamil Nadu's efforts. Meanwhile, former ministers like H.N. Nanje Gowda and K.S. Eswarappa are also awaiting the